

Ramkumar Rani

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Results-driven AI/ML & Data leader specializing in enterprise AI strategy, Agentic AI product development, and data-driven transformation in financial services, advisory and regulated industries. Leading KPMG Advisory's AI and Data practice, driving AI-First strategies that boosted AI adoption by 40%+, generated \$15M+ in client revenue, and driven 20–25% efficiency at scale. Deep hands-on expertise in Gen AI, Agentic AI, LLMOps, AI Governance, and Azure data services. Proven building high-performing global teams, C-Suite partnerships, and transitioning prototype to production-scale, cloud-agnostic products that deliver measurable outcomes. Seeking a new role to accelerate and manage enterprise AI transformation. Consistent Learner.

CORE COMPETENCIES

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| ■ AI/GenAI/Agentic AI Product Strategy, Roadmap & Vision | ■ AI Product Discovery, PRDs & Requirements |
| ■ AI Product Development (0 → 1 → Scale), FDE | ■ C-Suite Advisory & Stakeholder Management |
| ■ AI Governance (EU AI Act, NIST AI RMF) | ■ Rapid Prototyping & POC-to-Production; LLMOps |
| ■ RAG, LLM, VLM & Embedding Models | ■ Cross-Functional Team Leadership |
| ■ Azure AI Foundry & Data Engineering | ■ Product Metrics, KPIs & ROI |
| ■ Financial Services Domain Expertise | ■ Customer/Client Engagement & GTM |

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

KPMG US

Senior Director — Applied AI & Data, Engineering | Hybrid / NJ | September 2022 – Present

AI Product Strategy, Vision & Business Impact

- **AI Product Strategy & Vision:** Defined and executed the AI product vision, strategy, and multi-year roadmap for KPMG Advisory and clients — driving 40%+ increase in AI adoption and aligning product bets with business OKRs.
- **Product Portfolio Ownership:** Own an AI product portfolio spanning Agentic AI, RAG, and LLM-powered platforms. Prioritized high-impact use cases through disciplined intake, opportunity sizing, and product triage.
- **C-Suite Discovery & Partnerships:** Partnered with CTOs, CIOs, and C-Suite executives to translate strategic priorities into shippable products — improving clients' top-line growth and bottom-line operational performance.
- **Revenue & ROI:** Delivered AI products generating \$15M+ in client revenue and 18–20% ROI improvements via outcome-focused roadmap prioritization and rigorous business-case discipline.
- **Product-Led Growth:** Identified and shaped new AI product opportunities; established the AI product operating model to sustain growth, differentiation, and repeatable delivery.
- **Cross-Functional Leadership:** Aligned engineering, data, design, DevOps, and risk/compliance around shared product outcomes — instituting discovery, planning, and delivery rituals; served as the single accountable owner across squads.
- **LLM Cost & Unit Economics:** Authored enterprise guidelines for open-source and commercial LLM usage, reducing token-consumption cost 12–18% and improving product unit economics.
- **Team Building & FDE:** Built and mentored a high-performing global matrix product/AI team of 20+; led product-management upskilling and knowledge-sharing programs; led FDE teams covering Financial Services.
- **AI CoE Founder:** Founded and run the Advisory AI Center of Excellence — vendor management, build-vs-buy analysis, rapid prototyping/POC, framework evaluation, technical demos, and adoption of emerging AI techniques.

Product Discovery, Delivery & Agentic AI Products

- **End-to-End Product Ownership:** Own full product lifecycle from discovery to launch and scale (0 → 1 → scale). Authored PRDs, defined success metrics, wrote user stories, and shipped reusable AI capabilities. Proactively surfaced product risks and mitigations to Senior Partners and client CTOs. Acted as connective tissue between business stakeholders and engineering.
- **Agentic AI Products:** Led product management of complex Agentic AI solutions delivering measurable business value — 20–25% cost-efficiency savings on average, with improved client experience, productivity, and risk management. Shipped impactful, production-grade Agentic AI products.

Signature Agentic AI & Gen AI Product Deliveries (Sample):

- **Agentic AI Contract IQ (Product), Product Manager — \$1.5M Initiative**
- Owned end-to-end product delivery of Contract IQ (from discovery through post-launch), replacing a costly vendor platform and consolidating disparate KPMG contract systems. Enabled automated ingestion of complex contracts/invoices, detecting leakage, recovering funds, and optimizing labor costs. Delivered POC in 3 days.
- **Product Roadmap:** Authored the product roadmap based on customer needs, business outcomes, and expected ROI.
- **Success Metrics:** Defined RAG evaluation metrics — Contextual & Answer Relevancy; Agentic AI triggered when Answer Relevancy < 0.85.
- **Release Management & Deployment:** Partnered with engineering on Azure DevOps CI/CD; managed release cycles, feature flags, and rollout planning; Docker containerization with ACR/AKS on WebApps.

- **Tech Stack:** Agentic AI (self-corrective RAG), LLM, Embedding Models, Azure Doc Intelligence, RAG evals, PostgreSQL, Azure Cosmos DB, Neo4j, Azure AI Search, React.js, LangChain/LangGraph/LangSmith, Claude Code. Cloud-agnostic.
- **Impact:** \$200M revenue opportunity; contract business automation and efficiency improvements.
- **Time-to-Value:** Instituted TTV tracking for onboarding new clients — value realization improved substantially vs. incumbent vendor TTV. Coordinated across management (financials, retail, etc.), vertical teams, and stakeholders.
- **Agentic AI + MCP Financial Risk Analytics**
- Identified a new product opportunity and shipped an Agentic AI product leveraging MCP to improve financial risk analytics using bank data. Baked in AI Governance and robust evaluation frameworks from day one.
- **Impact:** 35% improvement in risk accuracy, 55%+ operational efficiency, and \$500K in savings within 6 months.
- **RAG Content Harvesting Platform (Product)**
- Defined and shipped an advanced RAG product with Flash re-ranker and robust evaluation mechanisms, delivering business taxonomy insights and thought leadership to KPMG and clients.
- **Impact:** 100%+ operational efficiency improvement; matured into a full product generating \$3M+ revenue over 2 years.

AI Governance, Platform & Enablement

- **AI Governance (Product-Led):** Designed and implemented an ethical AI governance framework for KPMG and clients, aligned with EU AI Act and NIST AI RMF. Leveraged Credo.ai to embed Trusted & Responsible AI into the product lifecycle, lowering governance implementation cost 15–20%.
- **LLMOps & Release Management:** Drove enterprise-scale LLMOps strategy and agent lifecycle management using ADO pipelines, CI/CD, Docker, and AKS/ACR. Managed both open-source (Llama) and commercial models (Azure OpenAI, Google Gemini, Anthropic) across the product portfolio.
- **Data Platform Partnership:** Co-led Azure data pipeline strategy, migration to Microsoft Fabric, and data privacy management via Azure Purview — data lineage and data quality frameworks powering AI products.
- **UX & Client-Facing Products:** Owned UI/UX direction for client-facing products such as Contract IQ and Fin Insights — partnering with design on user research, journeys, and prototypes.
- **Developer & Product Tooling:** Championed Claude Code for Agentic AI development; strategized Azure AI Foundry adoption; scaled Microsoft Copilot for team-wide productivity gains; led fine-tuning of models for domain-specific product use cases; leveraged GitHub Copilot for development velocity.

BigR.io

SVP – Data Science | Hybrid/NJ | May 2021 – July 2022

- Strategy and development of BigR.io projects and products — for BigR.io and clients. Built and led a high-performing DS team. Contributed to GTM and Pre-sales. Established the partnership with DataRobot.
- Delivered a predictive modeling for SaaS healthcare payor solution using XGBoosting (on Azure), achieving an F1 score > 0.85. Impact: Revenue stream of \$1M/year. Developed a binary predictive model using Random Forest, including feature engineering. Resulted in improved prediction stability and accuracy over 30% compared to existing model.
- Ran daily project management (sprint cycle) call for tracking and management.

Credit Suisse (now UBS), Consulting

Data Scientist | NY/NY | Sep 2019 – May 2021

- Delivered enterprise-scale Repo, Collateral, and Margin (RCM) trading booking system using Bi-LSTM NER Deep Learning. Achieved F1 score > 0.87. Resulted in saving over \$800K/year. Replaced rule-based trading system. Used by 20+ RCM Credit Suisse/UBS traders.
- Provided DS leadership. Built a solid 10-member DS and data team. Developed MLOps on AWS cloud.

UST

Director, AI / ML | Aliso Viejo, CA/NJ | May 2018 – Sep 2019

- AI/ML Founding Director. Built and mentored a strong global data science team (US & India).
- Managed DS horizontal for UST and clients, resulting in a revenue stream of \$25M.
- Developed and managed UST Flagship product (AutoML) with a revenue base of \$40M. Built a business predictive model for financial client using LSTM. Achieved a superior F1 metric > 0.90.

JP Morgan Chase

Vice President, Global Technology (GT) | NY/NY | Jan 2014 – May 2018

- Initiated ML within GT group. Developed Anomaly Detection using Deep Learning, replacing a rule-based engine. Developed Risk pricing ML engine using Random Forest; achieved a low MSE, employing solid hyper-parameter optimization.
- Managed global Ref Data platform on Big Data (Hadoop). Performed Oracle fine-tuning — SQL and DB tuning. Improved Oracle SQL performance by an impressive 75%.

Barclays

Vice President, Risk Technology | NY/NY | July 2009 – Jan 2014

- Developed a robust ETL and database backend on Oracle Exadata platform. Supported credit, IR, and liquidity risk businesses.
- Hired and managed ~50-member global matrix team: US, UK, India, and Singapore.

[Earlier career in Financials on Wall Street — Citi, Deutsche]

TECHNOLOGY EXPERTISE

- **AI/ML Frameworks:** LangChain, LangGraph, LangSmith, Claude Code, Credo.ai, Hugging Face, PyTorch
- **LLMs & Models:** Azure OpenAI (GPT-4o/5), Anthropic Claude, Google Gemini, Meta Llama, VLMs, Embedding Models
- **Cloud & Data:** Azure AI Foundry, Azure Cosmos DB, Azure AI Search, Azure Purview, Microsoft Fabric, PostgreSQL, Neo4j, FAISS
- **DevOps & Infra:** Azure DevOps (ADO), CI/CD Pipelines, Docker, AKS (Kubernetes), GitHub, LLMOps/MLOps
- **Governance:** EU AI Act, NIST AI RMF, Credo.ai, Trusted & Responsible AI, AI Risk Management
- **Product & Frontend:** PRDs, Roadmapping, Metrics/KPIs, React.js, UI/UX Design Oversight, Rapid Prototyping

EDUCATION

Master of Science — Computer Science (Minor: Statistics)

Rutgers University, New Brunswick, NJ

KEY DIFFERENTIATORS

- AI product leader — Leadership on AI Product Strategy & Enablement, AI-First, AI-Native development
- Hands-on technical product leader — writes PRDs, aligns architecture, and leads delivery simultaneously
- Entrepreneurial mindset — founded AI CoE; balance innovation with disciplined business delivery
- Strong business and technical communication; documentation and vendor management excellence
- Proven track record transitioning POCs to production-grade enterprise AI products
- Financial Services domain focus with deep understanding of risk, compliance, and regulatory AI requirements